

Haoyu Zhai

Division of Social Science
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PROFILE

Quantitative social scientist with doctoral training in applied statistics and econometrics. Taught graduate methods at the European University Institute, running computer lab sessions, preparing problem sets, and handling assessment for a course delivered jointly with the Department of Economics. Led weekly small-group undergraduate tutorials at the University of Oxford, advising students on academic progress and examination preparation. Currently Research Associate in the Division of Social Science at NYU Abu Dhabi, with an applied research agenda in political economy, political finance, and economic history.

EDUCATION

- Ph.D. Political and Social Science, European University Institute, Florence, 2023
Dissertation: Three Papers in Applied Political Methodology
- M.Res. Political and Social Science, European University Institute, Florence, 2020
- M.Phil. Comparative Government, University of Oxford, 2019
Affiliated Graduate Student, Centre for Experimental Social Sciences (CESS)
- B.Sc. Politics with Quantitative Research Methods (*First Class Honors*), University of Bristol, 2017

TEACHING AND INSTRUCTIONAL EXPERIENCE

European University Institute

- 2020–21 **Statistics of Causal Inference**, Graduate elective
Teaching Assistant
- Co-administered a graduate methods course delivered jointly with the Department of Economics, serving a full cohort across the social sciences.
 - Ran computer lab sessions in R, prepared and maintained curriculum materials and problem sets, and held regular office hours.
 - Managed grading logistics and assessment records, and provided individual feedback on student assignments.

University of Oxford

- 2018–19 **Political Sociology**, Undergraduate elective, Worcester College
College Tutor
- Led weekly small-group undergraduate tutorials in the Oxford tutorial format.
 - Advised students on academic progress, essay technique, and examination preparation.

Research Mentoring and Training

- 2023–26 New York University Abu Dhabi
- Supervise and train undergraduate research assistants in statistical software, data management, and reproducible workflow practice.

- 2021 LSE Data Science Institute
 - Delivered an invited instructional session introducing the COVID-19 Model Challenges to a mixed graduate and practitioner audience at a CIVICA Research hackathon.

COURSEWORK IN ECONOMICS AND QUANTITATIVE METHODS

Courses completed for credit or audited at the host institution.

- 2026 Advanced Macroeconomics (undergraduate), New York University Abu Dhabi
 2025 Topics in Financial Econometrics (undergraduate), New York University Abu Dhabi
 2025 Econometrics (graduate), New York University Abu Dhabi
 2024 Mathematical Statistics and Probability (graduate), New York University Abu Dhabi
 2024 Game Theory (graduate), New York University Abu Dhabi
 2024 Mathematics II (graduate), New York University Abu Dhabi
 2023 EITM Summer Institute (Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models)
 2023 ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan
 2021 Statistical Machine Learning (graduate), Bocconi University
 2021 Numerical Methods for Economists (graduate), Sciences Po
 2021 ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan
 2020 Statistics and Econometrics I–II (graduate), European University Institute

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2023–26 New York University Abu Dhabi
Research Associate, Division of Social Science
 - Conduct quantitative research in political economy, economic history, development, and political behavior in collaboration with multiple faculty members.
 - Manage and analyze large-scale datasets, including full-count census microdata, geospatial and climatic data, survey and field experiments, and administrative records.
 - Design and implement statistical workflows in R, Python, and GIS software for data management, visualization, causal inference, and policy evaluation.
 - Contribute to research design, literature reviews, manuscript preparation, technical reports, and reproducible research pipelines.
 - Use high-performance computing resources for large-scale data processing.
- 2022–23 WZB Berlin Social Science Center
Visiting Researcher, Institutions and Political Inequality Research Unit
- 2020–23 European University Institute
Research Assistant, Department of Political and Social Sciences
- 2018–19 University of Oxford
Research Assistant, Nuffield College, 2019
Research Intern, Kellogg College, 2018
- 2016 Institute of Economic Affairs, London
Research Intern

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- 2025 S. Weber, N. Stoop, P. van der Windt and H. Zhai. "A Meta-Analysis of Attitudes Towards Migrants and Displaced Persons." *British Journal of Political Science* 55:e168, 1–30. doi:10.1017/S0007123425101075
- 2025 J. Barceló, C. Paik, P. van der Windt and H. Zhai. "A Global Ranking of Research Productivity of Political Science Departments." *PS: Political Science & Politics* 58(3), 574–585. doi:10.1017/S1049096524001239
- 2024 J. Barceló, J. L. Jensen, L. Peisakhin and H. Zhai. "New Estimates of US Civil War Mortality from Full-Census Records." *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 121(48), e2414919121. doi:10.1073/pnas.2414919121
- 2023 J. Lindvall, D. Rueda and H. Zhai. "When Parties Move to the Middle: The Role of Uncertainty." *British Journal of Political Science* 53(4), 1208–1229. doi:10.1017/S0007123422000758
- 2022 S. Garside and H. Zhai. "If Not Now, When? Climate Disaster and the Green Vote Following the 2021 Germany Floods." *Research & Politics* 9(4), 137401. doi:10.1177/20531680221141523

Under Review

- M. A. Golden, T. Slough, H. Zhai et al. "The Model Challenges: Gathering, Aggregating, and Evaluating Covid Mortality Models." *Perspectives on Politics*, under review.
- C. Paik and H. Zhai. "The Mongol Conquest and Development in Eurasia before the Age of Exploration." *British Journal of Political Science*, under review.

Work in Progress

- H. Zhai. "Political Deliberation as Network: An Applied Methodological Note."
- H. Zhai. "Presidential Elections and Cryptocurrency Returns: Evidence from 2020 and 2024."
- C. Wang and H. Zhai. "A New Bayesian Structural Scaling Approach to Party Position and Issue Salience."
- H. Zhai. "A Theory-based Optimization Method for Measuring Intraparty Unity in Coalition Bargaining."

CONFERENCE ACTIVITY

Conference Papers Presented¹

- 2024 C. Paik and H. Zhai. "The Mongol Conquest and Development in Eurasia before the Age of Exploration." *LEGACIES* Workshop on Historical Institutions and Legacies. Norwegian University of Science and Technology, Norway. Nov 18–19.
- 2023 H. Zhai. "Estimating Party Unity Scores with Formal Support: A New Gamson-Cox Approach." American Political Science Association Annual Meeting & Exhibition. Los Angeles, California. Aug 31–Sep 3.

Invited Talks

- 2021 "An Introduction to the COVID-19 Model Challenges." CIVICA Research: Collaborative Hackathon on Data-Driven Technologies for Social Sciences. LSE Data Science Institute, UK. Oct 21.

¹Presenting author *italicized* if other than first author.

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Awards and Honors

- 2017 UK Data Service Dissertation Prize
Best Undergraduate Research Using Quantitative Research Methods
- 2016 Bristol Evelyn Miller-Barstow Prize
Exceptional Academic Performance in Undergraduate Study

Competitive Grants and Fellowships

- 2024 *LEGACIES* Workshop Travel Grant (ERC project funding)
- 2023 Warren E. Miller Scholarship for ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods
- 2023 Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models Summer Institute Scholarship (NSF grant)
- 2022–23 European University Institute Graduate Research Expenses ($\times 2$)
- 2022–23 Society for Political Methodology Conference Travel Grants ($\times 2$)
- 2021 EITM Certification Scholarship for ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods
- 2020 Berkeley Initiative for Transparency in the Social Sciences Scholarship
- 2019–23 Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs Ph.D. Studentship
- 2019 University of Oxford St Catherine’s College Graduate Research Fund
- 2016 University of Bristol Q-Step Internship Scheme
- 2014 University of Bristol SPAIS International Scholarship

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- 2025–26 Editorial and design support, newsletter of the APSA Comparative Politics Section

TECHNICAL AND LANGUAGE SKILLS

Programming and Data Analysis: R, Python, Julia, GIS, High-Performance Computing (HPC)

Quantitative Methods: Econometrics, causal inference, game theory, applied Bayesian models, survey and field experiments, meta-analysis, spatial analysis, statistical machine learning

Research and Teaching Tools: L^AT_EX, Git, Markdown, R Markdown, Microsoft Office, Adobe InDesign

Languages: English (fluent), Chinese (native), Italian and German (basic)

REFERENCES

Prof. Andrea Ichino

Professor of Economics
University of Bologna
Andrea.Ichino@eui.eu

Prof. Christopher Paik

Associate Professor of Political Science
New York University Abu Dhabi
christopher.paik@nyu.edu

Prof. Valentina Corradi

Professor of Economics
New York University Abu Dhabi
vc2718@nyu.edu

Prof. Peter Cornelis van der Windt

Associate Professor of Political Science
New York University Abu Dhabi
petervanderwindt@nyu.edu